

An unbroken line of our precedents sustains the federal courts' jurisdiction of the subject matter of federal constitutional claims of this nature. The first cases involved the redistricting of States for the purpose of electing Representatives to the Federal Congress. When the Ohio Supreme Court sustained Ohio legislation against an attack for repugnancy to Art. I, § 4, of the Federal Constitution, we affirmed on the merits and expressly refused to dismiss for want of jurisdiction "In view . . . of the subject-matter of the controversy and the Federal characteristics which inhere in it" *Ohio ex rel. Davis v. Hildebrant*, 241 U. S. 565, 570. When the Minnesota Supreme Court affirmed the dismissal of a suit to enjoin the Secretary of State of Minnesota from acting under Minnesota redistricting legislation, we reviewed the constitutional merits of the legislation and reversed the State Supreme Court. *Smiley v. Holm*, 285 U. S. 355. And see companion cases from the New York Court of Appeals and the Missouri Supreme Court, *Koenig v. Flynn*, 285 U. S. 375; *Carroll v. Becker*, 285 U. S. 380. When a three-judge District Court, exercising jurisdiction under the predecessor of 28 U. S. C. § 1343 (3), permanently enjoined officers of the State of Mississippi from conducting an election of Representatives under a Mississippi redistricting act, we reviewed the federal questions on the merits and reversed the District Court. *Wood v. Broom*, 287 U. S. 1, reversing 1 F. Supp. 134. A similar decree of a District Court, exercising jurisdiction under the same statute, concerning a Kentucky redistricting act, was

Amendment. *Douglas v. Jeannette*, 319 U. S. 157; *Stefanelli v. Minard*, 342 U. S. 117; cf. *Nixon v. Herndon*, 273 U. S. 536; *Nixon v. Condon*, 286 U. S. 73; *Snowden v. Hughes*, 321 U. S. 1; *Smith v. Allwright*, 321 U. S. 649; *Monroe v. Pape*, 365 U. S. 167; *Egan v. Aurora*, 365 U. S. 514.